PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

OFFICE OF OPERATIONS

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Date: November 4, 2025

To: School Board

From: Jon Franco, Senior Chief of Operations

Subject: Adoption of Ida B Wells High School Revised Comprehensive Plan

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BACKGROUND

Board Resolution 6153 referred the planning and design for the Ida B Wells High School Modernization project to voters as a part of the 2020 bond. On May 7, 2024, Board Resolution 6900 adopted the Ida B Wells High School Modernization Comprehensive Plan. On April 11, 2025, Board Resolution 7051 adopted a Framework for Delivering Modernized High Schools in a Cost-Efficient Manner.

The Ida B Wells High School Modernization Project Team (Project Team) has worked with internal stakeholders, external stakeholders, a community Design Advisory Group and the internal Ida B Wells Modernization Steering Committee to develop a Revised Comprehensive Plan in conformance with the framework established by Resolution 7051.

Finally, this Revised Ida B Wells HS Comprehensive Plan was first shared at the Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee (FIOC) and that committee reviewed and recommended to forward it to the full Board. The November 4, 2025 Board meeting date was scheduled.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

The PPS 2017 Comprehensive High School Educational Specifications (2017 Ed Specs), along with information on current Ida B Wells High School programming, was used as the basis for programming of the modernized Ida B Wells High School. The Ida B Wells High School Comprehensive Plan was also informed by space programming needs of the PPS Climate Crisis Response Policy.

In addition to using these documents as the foundation for the Ida B Wells High School program, the Project Team conducted a rigorous outreach and engagement effort over several months. The Project Team met with internal and external focus groups and developed a Comprehensive Plan report for Ida B Wells High School that presents the desired room requirements, the interrelationships of spaces, specific room requirements and square footages, and most importantly, represents the core educational values of PPS.

The Framework for Delivering Modernized High Schools in a Cost-Efficient Manner included guidelines to meet the PPS 2017 Comprehensive High School Educational Specification's

(2017 Ed Specs) minimum requirements for number and size of spaces, meet the needs of the PPS Climate Crisis Response Policy for all-electric infrastructure, reduce the overall size of the project, and develop additional cost reduction options. The Ida B Wells High School Revised Comprehensive Plan is a result of applying the framework to the design and reducing the overall cost of the project while maintaining the core educational values of PPS.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

The existing Ida B Wells High School (IBW), located in the Hillsdale neighborhood of Southwest Portland and immediately adjacent to Rieke Elementary School, was built in 1956 and is 260,900 square feet. It currently serves approximately 1,650 students. The 26-acre site, largest of all PPS high school sites, includes a full range of athletic fields, as well as an outdoor public pool owned and maintained by the City of Portland.

A Conceptual Master Planning effort was undertaken in late 2019 to provide a basis of cost estimating for future project planning. Based on cost information and other project prioritization, the Board of Education included $20M for planning and design for the Ida B Wells High School Modernization project on the 2020 Bond, with the understanding that funds for construction would need to be included for voter approval in a later bond measure.

As part of the Ida B Wells High School Comprehensive Plan, the Project Team developed a detailed Area Program Summary that refines the PPS High School Education Specifications so that the program meets the specific requirements for Ida B Wells High School.

In accordance with direction from the Board of Education Facilities & Operations Committee at the February 28, 2024, meeting, the IBW Comprehensive Plan leaves the existing pool in place to continue operating as it has been. The restrooms and lockers that currently serve the pool will be demolished as they are within the existing school building that is also intended for demolition. A new restroom and locker facility will be provided as part of the Ida B Wells High School Modernization project.

The IBW High School Modernization project is utilizing the PPS Design Standards, Guidelines and Educational Specifications (Ed Specs) to provide facilities that compare equitably to the recently completed comprehensive high school facilities at Roosevelt, Franklin, Grant, McDaniel, and Lincoln.

FISCAL IMPACT

The total project budget identified in the 2020 Bond materials for the planning and design for the Ida B Wells High School Modernization project was $20,000,000. While rough cost estimates were developed as part of the 2019 Conceptual Master Plan effort, it was understood that new cost estimates would be developed in conjunction with this IBW Comprehensive Plan.

The Project Team utilized professional cost estimators to establish a project budget. The approved IBW Modernization project budget was $455,000,518. After following the framework of Resolution 7051 for the Cost Reduction Study, the Revised Comprehensive Plan budget is now $449,350,000 resulting in just over $5,600,000 in savings.

It is worth noting that any delay in the proposed project schedule provided in the IBW Comprehensive Plan Presentation will result in significant additional costs in market escalation that are not included in the estimated project budget.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

The comprehensive planning phase for Ida B Wells included a broad community engagement program. A Comprehensive Planning Committee (CPC) met to review, discuss and recommend next steps for the comprehensive plan of the modernization project. Since Comprehensive Plan approval in May of 2024 the Design Advisory Group has convened for

multiple meetings.

Additionally, specific engagement efforts are conducted to include voices from other community groups including those historically underserved and/or underrepresented. More detail about this engagement process is included in the Ida B Wells Revised Comprehensive Plan. Presentations and feedback exercises were also facilitated with Ida B Wells staff, Ida B Wells student leadership groups, and broader engagement with Ida B Wells students.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

If the proposed Ida B Wells Revised Comprehensive Plan is approved, the Architecture/Engineering project team will continue forward with design development and construction documents. This will take place in coordination with ongoing community engagement, including the community-based Design Advisory Group as well as open houses, small focus groups, and other engagement activities.

Construction is scheduled to begin by December 2026 per the schedule provided in the attached Ida B Wells Revised Comprehensive Plan. The modernized Ida B Wells High School is scheduled to complete construction in 2029 and open for staff and students for the 2029-30 school year. After the existing building is demolished, the remaining fields will be completed by fall 2030. Any delay in this schedule will incur significant additional costs in market escalation.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

The new modernized Ida B Wells High School will provide each student with an equitable, individualized, high-quality learning experience and the tools to reach their full potential within an environment that is safe, healthy, and joyful. The new Ida B Wells High School will embody PPS's Mission, Vision and Values, and its Climate Policy, to strengthen the future of its students and its communities.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Staff requests approval of the proposed Ida B Wells High School Revised Comprehensive Plan.

ATTACHMENTS

A. Ida B Wells HS Revised Comprehensive Plan Executive Summary
B. Ida B Wells HS Revised Comprehensive Plan Board Presentation